OwrPlan Project Documentation

Phase 0: Requirement Definition

12/01/26: Group Formation

- WhatsApp Group made

28/01/26: First Meeting

- Conveyed the Project Idea to everyone
- Got talking about basic UI/UX and focus stuff

05/02/26: Promoting Group Engagement

- Sent everyone a string of texts saying

> i want this **weekend to be an opportunity for all of you to take a second and think** how you would make this project if it was ur own personal project, u can write out what u think is needed, optional, or unnecessary
>
> as a sort of **warm-up exercise** so we're all on the same page and everyone gets to really plan out the system and UI design asw
>
> if u want more **concrete requirements**:
> - One line summary of what you would use an app like this for
> - Features you think are absolutely necessary
> - The overall flow of how the user interacts with the app
> - How you imagine this will be implemented
>
> Basically, **I don't want to be the only one participating in the planning phase** of the SDLC and think that yall are more than js people to do the coding
>
> **Saturday shaam tak** sab bata dena,
> Share images if u write out anything on pen and paper to plan

08/02/26: SE Proposal Submission

All my teammates sent their responses by the time I woke up, here's the summary

Person	Most Desired Features	Workload Management

Haleema	Group Management
	Scheduling Algo
	Expenses Calculator
	Plan Wheel
	Hangout Story Mode
	  Hangout History Map
	  Gallery
		None Mentioned

Ahmed	Good Scheduling Algo User Friendly UI Expenses Calculator	UI-first approach **SCRUM-lite** typeshi **Regular Sprints**
Alizeh	Schedule Visualization **Personal Scheduling** Expenses Calculator Smooth UI	UI-first approach UI code before Mid-1 Backend after Mid-2 **Strict Deadlines Desired**
Zoha	**Input format flexibility** **Location Attribute** for Schedules Expiration Dates Recurring Activities	+2 on Alizeh's view
Me	Schedule Visualization QoL Features **Responsive UI for Mobile Devices** **Animated UI with SVGs** Personal Scheduling	UI on Figma Before Mid-1 Frontend before Mid-2 Backend After Mid-2 Concrete Deadlines **Self-Assigned Tasks over Jira**

In light of this, the following is my attempt at summary of the hypothetical Complete OwrPlan before we get into feasibility analysis

#	Feature	Subproblems	Imp	Feas.
1	**Session Management**	Login/Signup	5	
2	**Person CRUD**	Color Assignment	5	
		Avatars		
		Add Group Tags		
3	**Group CRUD**	Color Assignment	5	
		People Assignment		
4	**Schedule CRUD**	Recurring v. One-Off	5	
		Expiry		
		Assign to Multiple Entities		
		Flexible Bulk Text Input		
		Location Field (Gmaps?)	3	
		Excel Input	1	
5	**Schedule Summarization**	Entity Selection/Deselection	5	
		Custom Start-End Times		
		Blocked Visualization		
		Block Merging for Larger Time Ranges		
		Text Summary Toggle	4	
6	**Event Scheduler**	Custom Constraints in Rule Form	5	
		Default Day-Night Awareness Rule		
		Default Commute Time Awareness Rule		
		Entity Attendance Priority Rules		
		Day + Slot Outputs		

7	**Expenses Calculator**	Subexpense Selection for Contributions	5	
		Transaction Sequence Generation		
8	**Activity Selection Wheel**	Restaurant Selection	1	
		Activity Selection		
9	**Hangout Story Mode**	Cutesy Map for Prior Events	1	
		Gallery / Journalling Mode		
10	**Personal Planner**	Deadlines View	1	
		Intention View		
11	**UI Stuff**	Custom Assets	5	
		Responsiveness for Mobile Devices	4	
		Light v. Dark Theme	2	
		Animations	3	

Phase 1: Modelling and UI/UX

13/02/26: Setting the Timeline

- Added the feasibility column to the above table (narrowed down project scope a little)
- Set the deadline for the first task to **February 27th** (**Friday**)
- Made a highly-detailed document listing the **requirements and instructions**
- Ahmed has been really eager to help and he also actively changed up the SE project proposal to better fit the requirements specified in the document shared.
- So, to make sure everyone is equally involved, I delegated the task of taking care of **the AHCI proposal document** to Zoha and Haleema.

14/02/26: AHCI Deliverable-I

- All Clusters Were Assigned
- AHCI Proposal work was done by Zoha, Ahmed and Alizeh since Haleema was busy

26/02/26: Problems

- The **Second Deliverable** for SE was assigned and it stated that we had to create a *Design Class Diagram.* Now, I initially planned this to be executed using just Functional Programming so I am crossed between two options to resolve this
    - Ask for a Project-specific exemption and make an EERD instead
    - Shoe-horn in classes wrapping the functions in the backend

  I definitely prefer the former, but I imagine it's not so straight forward
- Another issue was that since the Sessional exams were so demanding, no one had made any progress on the assigned tasks even though the deadline was just around the corner
- So, we **moved forward the deadline** for the low-fidelity UI prototyping **one day ahead** to the 28th (Saturday night)

28/02/26: Weekend Progress

UI Prototyping:

It was the deadline for the Prototypes and so there was a lot of activity.

- **Alizeh and Ahmed** spent a lot of time communicating with me and they made mental progress but the artefacts produced so far are rough on-paper sketches and I imagine introducing color and what not will make them see issues they hadn't considered.
    - Alizeh and I expressed opposing views on how transactions should be input, which was healthy because it indicates she cares enough to express dissent
- **Haleema** also DM'ed me asking for clarification and frankly she was really lost and I didn't respond to her in time because I was busy with my own work
    - I should probably be more attentive to her in the future, it's probably worth the investment even if the output is many times GPT-driven which lowkey pmo
- **Zoha** had forgotten the cluster she picked and submitted a canvas for one of my components
- As for **myself**, I designed the Entity Selection Modal in Photoshop and then went on to experiment with ideas of having a map icon to represent planning as decoration for a fairly content-less page. Moreover, I did not finish all I intended to but I am still relatively satisfied with my personal progress.

Our progress was far from ideal but it was a good step in the right direction. Moreover, we also learnt that **Deliverable-II** wasn't just SRS documentation and modelling but also UI wireframes.

Correspondence with TA:

In the past, **the TA had expressed casual dismissal of our idea** during the evaluation of the proposal and signalled rejection. This was only settled because we had gotten the idea greenlit by our instructor prior to the formal proposal.

Despite this patchy past, a little time before the sessionals, Hamna had sent me a vague time-sensitive email titled 'Urgent Meeting' that I only read at day-end. It turned out **she had come up with an idea that she would like to see in our project**. Naturally, we arranged for a time to meet and after around a month of correspondence we finalized a time to meet: Monday.

28/02/26: Communication

ERD v. Class Diagram:

We successfully got permission from our instructor to draw an ERD instead of a Class Diagram for our SRS documentation deliverable.

Meeting with Hamna:

I told my friends that they should join me in dipping out of the lab for 10-15 minutes to meet up with the TA and understand her proposal. Here are the details of her idea:

- When loading the activities of your friends also take in their **Location**
    - Zoha had previously expressed a similar idea that we left out for scope-control
- She said that the app should give the user **Notifications** if a friend of them was in the area and not free

The way she expressed this idea was only really suitable for a Multi-User environment whereas our system is to provide a single-user experience even if the web server is shared amongst many users. It is worth considering to show **on the dashboard** as soon as you log on.

Team Meeting and Prototyping Retrospective:

This brief 15 minute meeting wasn't the only meeting we had scheduled. We had also planned to meet after classes ended to discuss our progress in the UI. Unfortunately, **Ahmed forgot** about the meeting and only remembered after he had already left university so we had to continue on without him.

This meeting was quite productive as we ameliorated a lot of prior miscommunications. The following are the key highlights:

- I had identified that people struggled to understand the scope of their assigned tasks and were bleeding into doing stuff other people were assigned. I believed this was because they **didn't see the big picture**. So, we went over the component listing from the task allocation document I had written up.
- Zoha learnt that **our definitions for the term 'Activities'** were different
- **Haleema** nodded in agreement even though she didn't understand half of what I said
    - I noticed this and called her out on it because that's just bad for everyone
    - I still think I am privately underestimating the ability of people that think in a way that is fundamentally different from mine and this is mainly a communication issue that I need to work on. However, I have not yet had reason to believe otherwise either.
- Zoha and Alizeh expressed that they also **expected the output of the Best-time Algorithm to be persisted** in the database and so we decided that it should be handled like any other one-time activity but only if the user clicks a button to add it as a scheduled Activity.
- I basically just repeated what I had attempted to communicate in the document because there were some observable barriers in communication.

Personally, for future meetings **I want to make a point to listen more than I speak** as to ensure people aren't just agreeing with me because they are hesitant to speak and that they also feel equal ownership of the project.

Next Steps:

Regardless, we decided on the following next steps:

- Meeting on Wednesday to draw DFDs and ERD in person together
- Digitally illustrated UI by Friday Night
- Write-up on Saturday and Sunday

04/03/26: Modelling

- After SE we spent 2-3 hours making the EERD, DFDs and UCD for our project.
- We also identified more misalignments between individual expectations and talked a bit more about them

06/03/26: Group Meeting

Since AHCI Deliverable-II had been announced and required us to conduct a Survey, we hopped on a call and made the form together. In the same meeting, we also went over the requirements for SE Deliverable-II and self-assigned work as follows:

Abi	SRS Chapter 4
Haleema	SRS Chapter 1 – 3
Alizeh	SRS Chapters 1 – 3 (Support), ERD
Zoha	SRS Chapter 5, UCD
Ahmed	SRS Chapters 4 – 5 (Support), DFDs

07/03/26: UI Review

- Everyone shared their UI, I was late to review everyone's work
- Almost everyone's work felt really underwhelming to me and some of them felt like no thought had been put into it
- I tried to give constructive feedback and worked on improving my own UI components

08/03/26: SRS Document Started

I formatted the document, created all necessary headings with page breaks and got started with writing Chapter 4 of the document.

09/03/26: SRS Document Work

- Ahmed shared his DFDs
- Alizeh shared her EERD and her UI work
- Zoha shared her section of the SRS Writeup and her UI work
- Haleema shared her revised UI work after taking into account some of my feedback

10/03/26: SRS Document Completed

Ahmed and I stayed on call late cleaning up the document and finishing up the appendices and missing sections and we submitted the document 6 minutes before the deadline.

11/03/26: AHCI Deliverable-II Interviews

Since our form had stagnated at only 19 responses and we were running out of time, I instructed our team to conduct 5 interviews each with a special focus on their respective modules of the application.

For example, Alizeh was to focus on the expense sharing and visualization aspects, while I was to focus on the generative suggestions aspect of the application and the relevant problems associated with it.

13/03/26: AHCI Deliverable-II Write-up

At 8PM: Haleema, Zoha, and I started a meeting

- We started by discussing the write-up's goals, our progress with the interviews, and the overall structure of the document.

- We started copying the raw interview bodies into an appendix as was indicated by the requirements document for the deliverable.
- The call concluded a little before 10PM with Zoha and Haleema asking me to assign them work, saying that they will complete it by tomorrow.
- I did not like this because it was due in the morning and I would likely be asleep when the deadline passed.

At 10:30PM: Ahmed got free from taraweeh and hopped on call with me

- I caught him up with the details of the previous meeting
- We started formatting all the interviews.

At around midnight: Alizeh came home and joined the meeting

- She helped us format the interviews
- She wrote the methodology part with the details I asked her to fill in
- Ahmed put his attention to the forms and started making graphs for the responses for each question with Google Sheets
- I continued formatting all the interviews and then we quickly realized that the interviews alone were 70+ pages of content. However, it was a bit too late to reconsider
- Ahmed started using Claude to help analyze the interviews

By 4AM, we had all grown really tired and just AI slopped the document to completion and then submitted the final 90+ page document.

Phase 2: Implementation

18/03/26: Setup

I set up the monorepo and initialized the frontend with React, TailwindCSS.

19/03/26: Orientation

Web Dev:

I arranged for a meeting a day before and everyone said they would be free all day. At 2PM only Zoha was up, everyone else was asleep. By 2:30PM everyone except Haleema joined the meeting. Here, I went over some Web Basics and just introduced

- Front-end v. Back-end
- Node.js
- CommonJS vs ESM
- React.js
- Docker (no chance in hell they'll use it but imma set it up for myself anyway)

My goal was that by the end they understand basic file structuring and what each file does which seems to have succeeded. Additionally, Alizeh said she would give Haleema the rundown and help her catch up with us.

AHCI D-III:

Next, we looked at AHCI D-III and that gave me reason to pause and review work from the previous 'sprint.'

- I started by pointing out problems I had with my own work
    - I pointed out that I never finished the mobile wireframes for most of my pages
    - I told them about some issues I had with my current mockups
- I went on the SE SRS document and started reviewing one-by-one

    - We identified Palette Inconsistencies
    - Button Inconsistencies
- I pushed attention towards Wasted Space, Placement Issues and the lack of intention to design of Filters for the listing pages
- We realized it was due in exactly a week.

We tentatively discussed the idea of using Tuesday as the meeting day for AHCI and Wednesday as the day we spend working on the project but nothing was finalized.